

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in the letters to the editor section of a newspaper in Hong Kong:

Laid-back life in Taiwan is very tempting

I refer to Nick Westra's article "Why are so many Hongkongers moving to Taiwan?". I agree that a lot of people from Hong Kong are realising that Taiwan is the ideal place for them to settle down.

The living environment in Hong Kong is becoming more difficult. Costs keep rising in what is already one of the most expensive cities in the world, especially when it comes to property prices and rent. People have to work long hours to earn enough to cover living expenses. They don't have enough time to spend with their families and are so tired that on Sundays they often sleep all day.

Life in the city is too hectic, and the workplace is too competitive.

However, the pace of life is much slower in Taiwan. I think you can enjoy a much less complicated way of life there and being away from the fierce competition in Hong Kong's offices must be very liberating.

Families with children can have a good quality of life because, although the salaries are lower in Taiwan, the cost of living is also much lower.

While it is a big change in lifestyle, I am sure people who relocate to Taiwan will eventually adapt to living there and enjoy living there.

Lily Wong, Kwai Chung

Recently two of your classmates have left school and moved to Taiwan. You are discussing this with your group. You may want to talk about:

- the differences between Hong Kong and Taiwan
- the advantages and disadvantages of going to live in Taiwan
- the most important factor in deciding whether to move to Taiwan
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Would you like to visit Taiwan?
2. Would you like to live in Taiwan?
3. Do you think you will ever live in another country?
4. What do you think people miss when they move away from Hong Kong?
5. What problems do young people face when they move to another country?
6. Why do you think most Hongkongers work long hours?
7. Would you stay in touch with friends who move to another country?
8. Does modern communication make emigrating easier?